

Fourth Hong Kong Linguistics Olympiad

February 20, 2022

Solutions

Problem 1.

1. Verb structure:

- i.
- Tense
- :
- k-**
- = Past,
- n-**
- = Future

	sg.M	sg.F	pl.M	pl.F
1	-ana-	-en-*	-emi-**	
2	-ama-	-on-*		
3	-a-	-o-	-e-	-ere-

- iii.
- Root
- : If the root ends in a diphthong (e.g.
- ropoe**
-), an epenthetic consonant (EC) is added, which agrees with the subject as follows: 1sg:
- n-**
- 1pl:
- m-**
- 3sg/pl:
- r-**

- iv.
- Object
- :

1pl: **-mi-**** 2pl.M: **-pu-**** 3sg.M: **-ka-** 3sg.F: **-u-**** 3pl.M: **-i-**** 3pl.F: **-re-**

2. Phonological changes:

- i. **Nasal assimilation.** For the morphemes ending in **n** (*), the final **n** will assimilate the place of articulation from the following consonant (i.e. **n** > **ng** / **_ k** and **n** > **m** / **_ p**).
- ii. **Vowel reduction.** For morphemes starting or ending in **i** or **u** (**), that vowel will get reduced to the corresponding glide (**j** and **w**), if there is another vowel next to it (i.e. **i** > **y** / **{V _ or _ V}** and **u** > **w** / **{V _ or _ V}**)

(a)

1. *They(M) fought her.*
2. *I(F) will open her.*
3. *He deceived them(F).*
4. *You(SG, F) will be big.*

(b)

5. **noytiroy**
6. **kemirisimiw**
7. **nongkoni**
8. **kowra**

(c)

We will fold. (root = **pori**)
We will fold them(M). (root = **por**)
They(M) will fold. (root = **mipori**)
They(M) will fold. (root = **mipoi**)
They(M) will fold them(M). (root = **mipor**)